



Burt Podbere

Chief Financial Officer

2011

Founded

\$5.25B

Ending ARR (FY26)

\$1.01B

Net new ARR

97%

Gross retention

~25%

Non-GAAP op margin

01 Who You're Meeting

Burt Podbere — Chief Financial Officer, CrowdStrike.**In role:** CFO through CrowdStrike's private financing rounds and its 2019 IPO**Today:** Long-term financial management and the strategic direction of CrowdStrike's worldwide expansion — currently the shift from seat-based licensing to Falcon Flex consumption commitments.

A serial venture-backed CFO who has taken this company through the whole arc from private financing to public markets. He guided CrowdStrike through more than \$1B in equity financing and its high-profile 2019 IPO. Before CrowdStrike he held CFO positions at OpenDNS, Net Optics and Epocrates, with extensive international finance experience.

Career: Chief Financial Officer, CrowdStrike; Chief Financial Officer, OpenDNS; Chief Financial Officer, Net Optics; Senior finance leadership, Epocrates**The company:** Reached \$5.25B of ending ARR in FY2026 — the fastest and only pure-play cybersecurity software company to do so — while expanding non-GAAP operating margin by 370 basis points. Kurtz frames the market as consolidating onto Falcon as the operating system of cybersecurity for the agentic AI era.**What they sell:** The Falcon platform, sold as modules across endpoint, identity, cloud, exposure management and next-generation SIEM, with Charlotte AI providing agentic detection and response. Falcon Flex is the consumption-style licensing model driving consolidation onto the platform.

02 Where The Company Sits

The platform consolidation thesis is doing the work here. Falcon Flex lets customers commit spend and draw down across modules, and the module adoption numbers show it landing — 49% of customers on six or more modules, 24% on eight or more. For a portfolio owner that is the relevant mechanic: it is a vehicle for consolidating fragmented security spend across assets rather than a point product.

03 Talking Points

- Falcon Flex is a consumption commitment structure, and he owns how it is priced — the right counterpart for a portfolio-wide commitment.
- Three prior CFO roles at venture-backed security and health-tech companies; he negotiates for a living and expects the same.
- With margin expanding and net new ARR at a record, the company is not under pressure to discount. Structure and term will move further than price.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- Q4 FY2026 revenue of \$1.31B came in below the Wall Street consensus of roughly \$1.4B despite 23% growth
- The July 2024 outage remains the reference point for single-vendor concentration risk in critical infrastructure
- Management's \$10B ARR ambition implies sustained high growth against increasingly large comparatives

04 GIP Context

GIP: No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. Security tooling is one of the more plausible areas for genuine portfolio-level leverage — consolidated commercial terms across PortCos — and sits squarely in the Technology / Governance / Security prerequisite of the reference model.**BlackRock:** No publicly disclosed operating relationship; standard index holdings of CRWD only.**Others at CrowdStrike:** George Kurtz (Founder & Chief Executive Officer)www.crowdstrike.com · [CrowdStrike executive profile](#) · [FY2026 results](#) · [Company LinkedIn](#)

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